

Semester: 1EdTech TrustEd Apps Compliance, Competitive Benchmark, GTM, and University Packaging Playbook

Prepared: September 29, 2026

Purpose: A working audit sheet and commercialization plan for Semester as a unified university operating system.

Important: This is a self-assessment and planning document, not legal advice, a 1EdTech certification determination, or a guarantee of compliance. Validate all policy, contractual, accessibility, security, privacy, and AI statements with qualified counsel, accessibility specialists, security professionals, and 1EdTech's current program guidance before submission or public claims.

1. Executive summary

Semester's strategic differentiation is not that it has one more learning feature, planner, portal, AI assistant, or campus directory. It is that Semester connects the full university journey through one identity, one permission model, one action layer, one search layer, one workspace, one intelligence layer, and one institution governance console.

To become procurement-ready and category-leading, Semester must prove four things:

1. **Student value:** students repeatedly receive a clear, safe, explainable next action.
2. **Institutional value:** universities can connect fragmented workflows while preserving official systems of record.
3. **Trust:** privacy, security, accessibility, AI use, consent, data lineage, and retention are documented and technically enforced.
4. **Operational maturity:** the company can implement, support, measure, improve, and scale the platform predictably.

The recommended first institutional offer is the **Semester Registration and Path Pilot**: a time-bound, limited-data deployment for 25–100 students that helps them build a term plan, resolve schedule conflicts, save backup courses, prepare for advising, and understand their next action.

2. How to use this workbook

Use these status values in every audit row:

Status	Meaning
Not started	No documented control or evidence exists
Planned	Requirement is on a roadmap but not implemented
In progress	Work is underway but evidence is incomplete
Implemented	Control exists but needs validation or formal evidence
Validated	Control has been tested, documented, and approved
N/A	Not applicable; document why

Use these priority values:

Priority	Meaning
P0	Blocker before institutional data, public claim, or formal vetting
P1	Required for pilot or procurement readiness
P2	Required for broader institutional deployment
P3	Improvement after foundation is proven

3. TrustEd Apps audit matrix

1EdTech TrustEd Apps materials cover data privacy, security practices, accessibility, and generative-AI data practices. The following matrix converts those themes into an internal audit sheet. Review the current official rubrics before completing any formal submission.

3.1 Data Privacy matrix

ID	Audit area	Semester control target	Required evidence	Status	Priority	Owner	Next remediation
DP-01	Public privacy notice	Public, readable, current Privacy Policy describes collection, use, sharing, retention, deletion, and rights	Published policy URL; revision history	Not started	P0	Privacy lead	Draft policy from actual data map; legal review
DP-02	Terms of Service	Public terms accurately describe service rules, ownership, acceptable use, disputes, and subscription terms	Published Terms URL; version history	Not started	P0	Legal/operations	Finalize terms and publication workflow
DP-03	Data inventory	Every data field is classified by owner, purpose, source, access, retention, and processor	Data inventory; data dictionary; schema map	In progress	P0	Data governance	Complete field-level inventory and annual review process
DP-04	Data minimization	Integrations request only fields necessary for the active workflow	Connector scope registry; API mapping docs	Planned	P0	Integration lead	Add minimum-field rules and per-connector scope review
DP-05	Student data ownership	Student controls plans, drafts, files, goals, portfolio, and sharing choices	Student Data Promise; UI screenshots; policy tests	Planned	P0	Product/privacy	Publish promise and verify controls technically
DP-06	No sale of student data	No sale of student data; no education-record behavioral advertising	Public policy; contracts; vendor agreements	Planned	P0	Executive/legal	Publish explicit prohibition and contract language
DP-07	Advertising separation	Sponsored listings are labeled and do not influence academic or support recommendations	Advertising policy; design rules; test cases	Planned	P1	Product/marketing	Implement labels and recommendation separation

ID	Audit area	Semester control target	Required evidence	Status	Priority	Owner	Next remediation
DP-08	Subprocessors	Public list of subprocessors, purpose, data category, location, and update process	Subprocessor register	Not started	P0	Security/privacy	Build register and update process
DP-09	Retention	Defined retention schedule by data class and automated deletion/archival process	Retention policy; job logs; test evidence	In progress	P0	Data governance	Map every table and object-storage class
DP-10	Export and deletion	Students can export their data and request deletion; requests are auditable	Product flow; runbook; deletion tests	In progress	P0	Product/data steward	Validate end-to-end export/deletion and exceptions
DP-11	Consent	Sharing is explicit, purpose-limited, time-limited when appropriate, revocable, and audited	Consent schema; UX; audit log sample	In progress	P0	Product/privacy	Add consent expiry and revocation regression tests
DP-12	Parent/supporter sharing	No default access to student records; student consent is granular and revocable	Family-sharing policy; product flow	Planned	P1	Product/privacy	Limit categories and enforce expiry
DP-13	Data subject requests	Access, correction, export, deletion, restriction, and complaint process exists	Privacy request runbook; ticket workflow	Planned	P1	Data steward	Implement operational queue and SLAs
DP-14	Third-party sharing	No sharing outside disclosed, authorized purpose	Vendor DPAs; integration registry	Planned	P0	Legal/security	Add vendor approval and review process
DP-15	Cross-border processing	Processing locations and transfer safeguards are documented where relevant	Vendor records; legal review	Not started	P2	Legal/privacy	Document processor locations and transfer posture
DP-16	Cookies and analytics	Consent and telemetry practices are documented and configurable	Cookie policy; analytics inventory	Planned	P1	Marketing/data	Implement consent management and event governance

3.2 Security Practices matrix

ID	Audit area	Semester control target	Required evidence	Status	Priority	Owner	Next remediation
SEC-01	Security governance	Security owner, policies, risk register, review cadence	Security program charter; risk register	In progress	P0	Security lead	Assign named owner and quarterly review

ID	Audit area	Semester control target	Required evidence	Status	Priority	Owner	Next remediation
SEC-02	Secure SDLC	Threat modeling, code review, testing, dependency review, release gates	SDLC policy; PR template; CI screenshots	Planned	P0	Engineering	Make security checks mandatory in CI
SEC-03	Secrets management	No secrets in client code, Git history, logs, or screenshots; managed secret store and rotation	Secret-scanning reports; rotation runbook	In progress	P0	Engineering/security	Automate scanning and rotate discovered legacy secrets
SEC-04	Authentication	Secure sign-in, verification, recovery, session control, MFA for admins	Auth architecture; test evidence	In progress	P0	Identity lead	Enforce MFA and fresh auth for sensitive actions
SEC-05	Authorization	Least privilege, tenant isolation, object-level authorization, policy tests	Permission matrix; RLS tests; API tests	In progress	P0	Platform/security	Complete RLS/RPC remediation register
SEC-06	SECURITY DEFINER review	Every security-definer RPC has intended grants, safe search path, internal authorization, audit, and tests	RPC inventory; approval register	Not started	P0	Database/security	Triage and remediate all exposed functions
SEC-07	Database RLS	Every exposed table is classified and has intentional policy/grant behavior	RLS inventory; linter baseline	In progress	P0	Database/security	Resolve or formally allowlist all findings
SEC-08	Encryption	TLS in transit; encryption at rest; encrypted token and secret storage	Architecture diagram; vendor settings	Implemented	P1	Security	Validate and document evidence
SEC-09	Logging and audit	Sensitive reads, writes, sharing, exports, deletes, privilege changes, and integration changes are logged	Audit schema; sample reports	In progress	P0	Platform/security	Standardize event taxonomy and retention
SEC-10	Monitoring	Errors, latency, database health, sync health, queue health, and availability monitored	Dashboards; alert runbooks	In progress	P1	SRE/engineering	Define SLOs and actionable alert rules
SEC-11	Vulnerability management	Dependency scanning, SAST, secret scanning, patch SLAs, remediation tracking	CI reports; vulnerability policy	Planned	P0	Security	Add tools to CI and define severity SLAs
SEC-12	Penetration testing	Independent testing plan before institutional scale	Scope; report under NDA; remediation log	Not started	P1	Security	Budget and schedule after core controls stabilize
SEC-13	Incident response	Detection, triage, containment, communications, recovery, postmortem	IR plan; tabletop results	Planned	P0	Security/operations	Run first tabletop exercise

ID	Audit area	Semester control target	Required evidence	Status	Priority	Owner	Next remediation
SEC-14	Business continuity	Backups, tested restoration, RTO/RPO, disaster recovery, status page	Restore logs; DR plan	In progress	P0	SRE/operations	Schedule restore drill and publish status process
SEC-15	Vendor risk	Subprocessor assessment, contract controls, security review	Vendor register; assessment template	Planned	P1	Security/legal	Review AI, analytics, email, storage, payment vendors
SEC-16	Network and abuse controls	Rate limits, WAF, bot controls, DDoS posture, spam prevention	Firewall config; rate-limit design	Planned	P1	Platform/security	Add API and public-form abuse controls
SEC-17	File safety	Malware scanning, type validation, access controls, retention/deletion for uploads	File pipeline architecture; tests	Planned	P1	Engineering/security	Implement scan-before-processing workflow
SEC-18	Environment separation	Separate local/preview/staging/production; no production data in non-production by default	Environment inventory; access grants	In progress	P0	Engineering	Validate staging isolation and access boundaries

3.3 Accessibility matrix

ID	Audit area	Semester control target	Required evidence	Status	Priority	Owner	Next remediation
A11Y-01	Accessibility statement	Public statement, scope, known limitations, reporting path, response commitment	Published statement	Planned	P0	Accessibility lead	Publish statement and issue intake channel
A11Y-02	Standard baseline	WCAG 2.2 AA is an engineering acceptance baseline	Engineering policy; QA checklist	Planned	P0	Product/engineering	Add to definition of done
A11Y-03	Keyboard access	All critical workflows usable by keyboard with visible focus	Manual test results; automated tests	In progress	P0	Frontend	Audit critical flows and fix focus traps
A11Y-04	Screen reader support	Semantic structure, labels, landmarks, announcements, dialogs	Screen-reader test notes	Planned	P0	Frontend/accessibility	Test with NVDA/VoiceOver workflows

ID	Audit area	Semester control target	Required evidence	Status	Priority	Owner	Next remediation
A11Y-05	Contrast and color	Text and controls meet contrast; color is not sole status indicator	Design tokens; visual QA	In progress	P0	Design	Add contrast checks to design review
A11Y-06	Responsive reflow	Usable at 200–400% zoom and narrow devices without loss of function	Zoom/mobile tests	Planned	P1	Frontend	Add responsive QA matrix
A11Y-07	Reduced motion	Respect prefers-reduced-motion; no motion-only information	UI policy; tests	Planned	P1	Design/frontend	Implement motion token controls
A11Y-08	Captions/transcripts	Media content includes captions and transcripts	Media publishing checklist	Planned	P1	Content	Create caption/transcript process
A11Y-09	Documents and exports	Generated docs, slides, tables, charts, PDFs include accessible structure and prompts	Export test suite	Planned	P1	Workspace team	Build accessible-export acceptance tests
A11Y-10	Charts and data	Charts provide labels, data tables, alt text, units, and keyboard access	Component documentation	Planned	P1	Data visualization	Create accessible chart primitives
A11Y-11	Alternative access	Support route exists when a function has a temporary barrier	Help policy; issue queue	Planned	P1	Support	Add accessibility escalation route
A11Y-12	VPAT	Complete VPAT or formal, dated roadmap with accountable milestones	VPAT/roadmap	Not started	P1	Accessibility/legal	Engage qualified evaluator when core flows stabilize
A11Y-13	User preferences	Text, contrast, motion, reading, caption, notification settings persist across surfaces	Preference schema; UX	Planned	P2	Product	Build accessibility preference profile
A11Y-14	Inclusive research	Disabled students and accessibility specialists included in research	Research protocol; participant record	Planned	P1	Research	Establish paid advisory program

3.4 Generative AI matrix

ID	Audit area	Semester control target	Required evidence	Status	Priority	Owner	Next remediation
AI-01	AI disclosure	Publicly disclose where AI is used and what it does	AI Policy; product labels	Planned	P0	AI/product	Publish AI policy and in-product disclosures
AI-02	Provider register	Maintain approved model/provider list and data-processing terms	Provider register; vendor agreements	Planned	P0	AI/security	Record providers, purposes, regions, retention
AI-03	Data-use controls	No unauthorized training on student data; documented provider settings	Contract evidence; configuration record	Planned	P0	AI/legal	Verify provider data-use terms and settings
AI-04	Source permissions	AI only accesses selected/authorized materials and checks user access	Authorization tests; source map	In progress	P0	AI/platform	Implement source access checks before retrieval
AI-05	Source grounding	High-stakes educational outputs cite source pages, slides, timestamps, or official records	Output samples; evaluation suite	Planned	P0	AI/product	Build citation and missing-source behavior
AI-06	Academic integrity	Course/institution rules restrict prohibited use on active assessments	Policy engine; faculty controls	Planned	P0	Learning/AI	Implement course rules and refusal alternatives
AI-07	User choice	Students can control sources, model use where appropriate, AI history, and output deletion	AI controls UI; tests	Planned	P1	Product	Build controls and deletion paths
AI-08	Consequential action confirmation	AI cannot send, share, schedule, export, pay, register, delete, or modify records without exact preview and confirmation	UX evidence; audit tests	Planned	P0	Platform/AI	Build action registry and confirmation binding
AI-09	Prompt injection defense	Uploaded content is treated as data, not instructions; unsafe tool use blocked	Security tests; ingestion policy	Planned	P0	AI/security	Add adversarial test suite
AI-10	Quality evaluation	Evaluate correctness, citation quality, relevance, accessibility, integrity, safety, and cost	Evaluation dashboard; test set	Planned	P1	AI/research	Create domain-specific evaluation corpus
AI-11	Human escalation	Users can report wrong, unsafe, or irrelevant outputs and reach support	Feedback flow; incident playbook	Planned	P1	Support/AI	Add feedback taxonomy and triage SLA
AI-12	AI audit trail	Record provider, model class, source set, policy outcome, action request, and user confirmation	Audit event schema	Planned	P1	Platform	Implement privacy-aware AI audit events
AI-13	Equity and bias	Test recommendations and AI outputs across student contexts; avoid risk labels	Evaluation plan; governance review	Planned	P1	AI governance	Add equity review to release process

ID	Audit area	Semester control target	Required evidence	Status	Priority	Owner	Next remediation
AI-14	Annual review	Review AI inventory, providers, policy, controls, and evidence at least annually	Governance calendar	Not started	P2	AI governance	Establish annual review cadence

4. Technical remediation priorities

P0 – Must close before broad institutional data use

1. Complete the RLS and SECURITY DEFINER remediation register.
2. Confirm every public or exposed table, function, storage bucket, and API route has intentional access control.
3. Publish accurate Privacy Policy, Terms, AI Policy, accessibility statement, Student Data Promise, and subprocessor register.
4. Establish data inventory, data classification, retention schedule, and deletion/export process.
5. Enforce tenant isolation, object-level authorization, consent expiry, revocation, and audit logging.
6. Establish secure SDLC gates: secrets scanning, dependency scanning, test gates, migration review, and release approval.
7. Implement source lineage and freshness labeling in all high-impact student and institutional workflows.
8. Establish incident response, backup restoration tests, and operational ownership.

P1 – Required for repeatable pilots and procurement

1. Build an institution Trust Room and RFP answer library.
2. Implement connector contracts, integration health, stale-data states, reconciliation, and safe fallback behavior.
3. Add accessibility testing to CI and perform manual testing of critical student paths.
4. Build SSO, role configuration, feature flags, tenant configuration, and environment separation.
5. Add observability dashboards, critical-journey monitoring, error budgets, and support escalation.
6. Build AI policy controls, source-grounded outputs, course-level integrity rules, and confirmation gates.
7. Productize implementation with a sandbox tenant, setup checklist, templates, and training assets.

P2 – Required for broad campus scale

1. SCIM provisioning and advanced enterprise identity controls.
2. Full integration command center and field-level reconciliation dashboard.
3. Formal VPAT and independent accessibility review.
4. Independent penetration testing and formal SOC 2 readiness program.
5. Multi-campus administration, advanced audit, regional hosting strategy if needed, and enterprise support model.
6. Career network, employer talent pool, and partner marketplace after opt-in and moderation controls mature.

5. Higher-education GTM launch strategy

5.1 Category narrative

Core message:

Universities do not have a software shortage. They have a connection problem. Semester is the unified operating system that turns disconnected systems, information, people, and services into one clear student journey.

Student-facing message:

College is complicated. Your path should not be. Semester brings your plan, courses, deadlines, study tools, support, campus life, and future goals into one connected place.

Institution-facing message:

Semester creates a connected student experience across academic planning, learning, advising, campus support, career readiness, and operations—while preserving governance, privacy, accessibility, and the authority of official systems.

5.2 Beachhead market

Start with a narrow, urgent workflow where value is easy to demonstrate:

Semester Registration and Path Pilot

- Cohort: 25–100 students.
- Best targets: first-year students, transfer students, athletes, advising-center students, or students in complex programs.
- Institution owner: academic advising, student success, registrar partnership, first-year experience, or a department.
- Student outcome: a credible plan, backup choices, resolved conflict, prepared advising conversation, and a clear next action.
- Institution outcome: more prepared students, visible friction, useful aggregate pilot evidence, and a low-risk pathway to expansion.

5.3 Buyer map

Buyer / influencer	Concern	Semester response
Vice president of student success	Student clarity, retention, belonging, service discovery	Action Center, resource discovery, advising preparation, outcome measurement
Provost / academic affairs	Academic progress, student experience, faculty workload	Path, planning, Course Studio, source-aware learning support
Registrar	Accurate data, registration boundaries, catalog governance	Read-only minimum-field integration, official handoff, source freshness
CIO / IT	Security, identity, integration, supportability	SSO, tenant isolation, connector framework, Trust Room
CISO / privacy office	FERPA, least privilege, audit, vendor risk	DPA, data map, RLS, audit, retention, incident plan
Accessibility office	WCAG, VPAT, student barriers	WCAG 2.2 AA baseline, accessibility roadmap, reporting and testing
Advising leaders	Better meetings, fewer reconstructed contexts	Student-controlled plan, agenda, scenarios, safe shares

Buyer / influencer	Concern	Semester response
Career center	Career readiness, skills evidence, opportunity discovery	Passport, portfolio, course-to-skill pathways, opt-in opportunities
Student leaders	Usability, belonging, practical value	Student advisory council, ambassador program, community tools
Procurement	Contract, risk, price, implementation certainty	Standard package, pilot SOW, pricing, trust evidence

5.4 Growth loops

Loop	Entry point	Value event	Conversion
Student utility	Free schedule builder, advisor agenda, registration checklist	Student saves a plan or resolves a conflict	Signup, referral, Plus/Pro
Advisor	Agenda and shared student plan	Better-prepared appointment	Department pilot
Pilot	Registration or transfer cohort	Clarity and readiness evidence	Annual institutional contract
Ambassador	Student leaders and campus creators	Peer adoption, content, club/event onboarding	Campus density and institutional leads
Content	Guides, webinars, student stories, tools	Useful public resource	Email capture and account creation
Partner	SIS/LMS/career/tutoring/community providers	More connected workflow	Referral, co-sell, ecosystem access
Community	Events, mentors, groups, portfolio showcase	Belonging and useful connection	Retention and campus expansion

5.5 GTM launch phases

Phase	Timeframe	Goal	Deliverables
Foundation	0–60 days	Make claims, trust materials, and core pilot workflow real	Trust Center, pilot page, secure onboarding, Path/Plan workflow, analytics
Design partners	60–120 days	Recruit 1–3 high-engagement pilot partners	Pilot SOW, cohort selection, student advisory group, implementation kit
Evidence	120–180 days	Generate credible proof	Outcomes report, student/advisor feedback, case study with approval
Repeatability	180–270 days	Turn one pilot into a productized program	Templates, training, RFP package, integration catalog, pricing
Expansion	270+ days	Add modules and institutions responsibly	SSO/LTI/SIS read integrations, Career/Campus modules, annual contracts

5.6 Launch metrics

Metric	Target purpose
Time to first value	Signup to saved plan, conflict resolved, or next action
Onboarding completion	Is the first-run experience clear?
Path Snapshot rate	Does the core promise activate?
Term plan saved rate	Is the planning workflow valuable?
Backup course rate	Is registration readiness improving?

Metric	Target purpose
Advisor agenda rate	Is the human workflow improved?
Search-to-action rate	Does discovery lead to a useful next step?
Student clarity score	Does Semester help students know what to do next?
Advisor usefulness score	Does it reduce reconstruction and improve meetings?
Week-4 retention	Is Semester becoming a durable habit?
Pilot expansion signal	Are stakeholders asking for more cohorts or modules?

6. University pricing and packaging

6.1 Product packages

Package	Target buyer	Core scope	Recommended commercial structure
Semester Free	Individual student	Profile, goals, one plan, basic schedule, directory, reminders	Free
Semester Plus	Individual student	Unlimited plans, comparisons, scenarios, calendar sync, sharing, export	\$7.99/month or \$59/year suggested
Semester Pro	Individual student	Advanced scenarios, career/portfolio, advisor collaboration, AI allowance	\$14.99/month or \$99/year suggested
Semester Registration Pilot	Department / institution	Registration and Path Pilot for 25–100 students	Fixed implementation + fixed pilot subscription
Semester Student Success	Institution	Today, Action Center, Path, advising, campus support discovery	Annual enrollment-band license
Semester Learning	Academic unit / institution	Course workspace, study assets, faculty policy, LTI integration	Annual license + implementation
Semester Career	Career center / institution	Passport, portfolio, skills, opportunities, mentors	Annual license + configuration
Semester Campus	Institution	Directory, events, organizations, opportunities, Campus Hub	Annual license + content onboarding
Semester Enterprise	Multi-campus / system	SSO, SCIM, advanced integrations, custom governance, enterprise support	Multi-year custom agreement

6.2 Pilot pricing model

Price pilots to ensure they are serious, funded, and convertible without making early adoption impossible.

Pilot fee = implementation + annualized cohort license + optional integration work + support tier

Suggested commercial rules:

- Charge implementation separately from software so the institution understands the real onboarding work.
- Credit part of the pilot fee toward an annual contract if the institution expands within a stated window.
- Include a clearly limited data scope and a list of excluded features.

- Define a success review at the end of the pilot rather than promising outcomes in advance.
- Price advanced integrations, custom migration work, and high-touch support separately.

6.3 Gross-margin model

$$\text{Gross Margin} = \frac{\text{Revenue} - \text{Direct Cost of Service}}{\text{Revenue}}$$

Direct costs include cloud/database, storage, AI inference, email/SMS, payment processing, implementation labor, customer success, integration operations, moderation, support, and third-party APIs.

Offer	Revenue drivers	Major variable costs	Margin target after maturity
Free	Lead generation and conversion	Infrastructure, support, limited AI	Managed acquisition cost
Plus	Subscription	Payments, cloud, limited support	75–85%
Pro	Subscription	AI, storage, advanced support	65–80%
Pilot	Fixed fee	Implementation labor, training, support	45–65% initially
Department	Annual license	Support, configuration, modest integrations	65–80%
Institution	Enrollment-band annual license	Customer success, integrations, support	60–75%
Enterprise	Multi-year platform agreement	Custom integrations, support, security	50–70% initially; improve over time

6.4 Margin-protection rules

1. Route AI requests by capability, sensitivity, cost, and policy; do not promise unlimited expensive model use.
2. Include AI allowances and paid overages only after usage patterns are understood.
3. Build connectors once; charge for unusual custom integrations.
4. Use templates, sandbox tenants, content imports, and training materials to reduce implementation labor.
5. Use in-product support, contextual help, and documentation to protect support margins.
6. Apply storage lifecycle rules and quotas to prevent unbounded file costs.
7. Default to in-app and push notifications; use SMS only when opted in and valuable.
8. Clearly label sponsored content and never let sponsorship alter academic or support recommendations.

7. Pilot RFP package

7.1 Recommended first pilot

Semester Registration and Path Pilot

Objective: Help a defined student cohort understand academic progress, prepare for registration, create a feasible term plan, resolve conflicts, save backup courses, prepare for advising, and identify the next safe action.

Cohort: 25–100 students.

Length: One registration cycle or 12–26 weeks.

Recommended sponsor: Student Success, Advising, First-Year Experience, Registrar partnership, or one academic unit.

7.2 Included capabilities

Secure account and student profile
Path Snapshot
Student-entered or approved program/requirement planning context
Term plan and course shortlist
Schedule and conflict view
Primary and backup course options
Registration readiness checklist
Advisor meeting agenda and safe share/export
Action Center
Source/freshness labels
Feedback and support route
Mobile and accessibility baseline
Aggregate pilot measurement

7.3 Explicit exclusions

Official registration execution
Official degree audit or certification
Automatic add/drop/withdrawal
Production SIS write integration
Full LMS replacement
Payment, housing, dining, health, emergency, or broad family portals
Unrestricted AI agents
Surveillance analytics or risk scoring
Public student social feed

7.4 RFP response outline

1. Executive summary
2. Student problem and institutional opportunity
3. Semester platform architecture
4. Pilot scope and exclusions
5. Student workflow diagrams
6. Roles, permissions, and consent model
7. Data scope and data minimization
8. Security, privacy, accessibility, and AI governance
9. Integration and official-system boundaries
10. Implementation timeline and responsibilities
11. Training and launch communications
12. Support and escalation model
13. Measurement plan and outcomes report
14. Commercial terms and pricing
15. Expansion roadmap
16. Appendices: policies, DPA, architecture, support SLA, Trust Center

7.5 Pilot success measures

Area	Measure
Activation	Account creation and onboarding completion
Planning	Path Snapshot viewed, term plan saved, backup course saved
Registration readiness	Checklist completion and conflict resolution
Advising	Agenda creation and student/advisor usefulness rating

Area	Measure
Clarity	“I understand what I need to do next” score
Discovery	Search-to-resource action and support handoff success
Operations	Content freshness, support response, integration health
Expansion	Demand for new cohort, workflow, module, or institutional agreement

8. District/K–12 note

K–12 should be a later, configured edition of the shared Semester platform—not a rushed separate product. Prioritize high-school graduation pathways, college and career readiness, CTE, dual enrollment, student portfolios, counselor workflows, and family-consented milestones.

Before district student data is processed, establish a district data agreement, age-aware controls, COPPA assessment for younger users, strict guardian and staff permission boundaries, no behavioral advertising, moderation and reporting safeguards, district-controlled AI policy, retention controls, and accessibility documentation.

9. Immediate action list

1. Build the TrustEd Apps evidence matrix as a tracked spreadsheet or database using Section 3.
2. Assign one accountable owner and review date to every P0 row.
3. Complete the RLS and SECURITY DEFINER remediation register before broad institutional data use.
4. Publish the Trust Center and the core public policy set.
5. Create the Registration and Path Pilot landing page, SOW, RFP response, price sheet, and implementation checklist.
6. Recruit one design partner and a 25–100 student pilot cohort.
7. Create a formal student advisory council and institutional advisory group.
8. Measure clarity, plan completion, conflict resolution, backup planning, advisor usefulness, and resource discovery.
9. Complete 1EdTech Data Privacy readiness first; then mature AI, accessibility, security, and interoperability evidence.
10. Convert each pilot into reusable implementation assets, security evidence, product improvements, and an approved case study.

10. Final benchmark test

Semester is ready to claim category leadership only when the answer is yes to every question below:

Can a student understand what matters and what to do next from one connected home?
 Can each important fact show its source, freshness, and limitation?
 Can a student control what they share, with whom, and for how long?
 Can an institution configure, govern, and monitor the platform without custom code?
 Can a buyer receive security, privacy, accessibility, AI, integration, and implementation evidence?
 Can a pilot launch safely in weeks with limited data and a measurable outcome?
 Can the team explain the operating cost, support plan, and implementation path for every package?
 Can Semester improve the student experience without becoming a surveillance system or a collection

When those answers are consistently yes, Semester will be positioned not as another edtech tool, but as the trusted operating system for the connected university journey.